

Φίντυς ἡ Σπαρτιᾶτις

Phintys of Sparta on Female Modesty

eul_aid: exi

Period: Κλασική Classical
Dialect: Δωρική Doric (phi, frg)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy
Format: Πραγματεία Treatise
Affiliation: Pythagorean

Phintys was a philosopher from Sparta who lived during the 4th century BCE. She was a follower of Pythagoreanism, a school of thought that included active female members. Very little is known about her personal life, though ancient sources identify her as the daughter of Callicrates.

She is credited with authoring a short treatise titled **On the Temperance of a Woman**, which survives in fragments. The work is a practical ethical guide focusing on the virtue of **sōphrosynē**, or moderation, as it applies specifically to women's lives. It discusses conduct related to piety, marriage, and personal adornment.

Phintys is historically important as one of the few named female philosophers from ancient Greece whose own writing has partially survived. Her work provides direct evidence that women contributed to philosophical authorship within the Pythagorean tradition. Her existence challenges the assumption that ancient philosophy was an exclusively male activity and offers insight into how ethical ideals were applied to different social roles in the ancient world.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · On Female Modesty · 4 passages

Other Pythagorean Authors

- Ἀπολλόδωρος ὁ Κυζικηνός · Apollodorus of Cyzicus · 1 work
- Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Τυανεύς · Apollonius of Tyana · 3 works
- Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Τυανεύς · Apollonius of Tyana II · 1 work
- Ἀρχύτας ὁ Ταραντῖνος · Archytas of Tarentum · 2 works
- Ἀρέσας ὁ Λευκανός · Aresas of Lucania · 1 work
- Ἀθάμας ὁ Ποσειδωνιάτης · Athamas of Posidonia · 1 work
- Βροντῖνος ὁ Μεταποντῖνος · Brontinus of Metapontum · 2 works
- Κέρκωψ ὁ Ὀρφικός · Cercops the Orphic · 1 work
- Κλεινίας ὁ Ταραντῖνος · Clinias of Tarentum · 2 works
- Δάμων καὶ Φιντίας · Damon and Phintias · 1 work
- Ἐχεκράτης ὁ Φλιάσιος · Echebrates of Phlius · 1 work
- Ἐκφαντος ὁ Πυθαγόρειος · Ecphantus the Pythagorean · 2 works